Haora Men’s Traditional Shawl

Resource Identifier: CULT-TRAD-001

English Translation: Ancestral Tangkhul Men’s Shawl

Category: Tradition | Subcategory: Attire

Village / Region: Ukhrul | Dialect: Ukhrul

Contributor / Source: Tangkhul Master Weavers (Traditional Craft (Hodson 1911, TLS Weaving Documentation))

License: Traditional Cultural Expression (Permissions: community_authorized)

Seasonal Timing / Occasion: Festivals, ceremonial summits, and high community occasions

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Ethnographic Summary & Context:

Renowned handwoven cotton shawl with white, red, and black bands, featuring delicate hand-stitched Ramik (eye of peacock) patterns along the edges. Worn by men during festivals.

Indigenous Tangkhul Text / Chants / Sayings:

"Haora kachonhi Tangkhul mayarnao wui aming kasak kachonna."
"Kakathara, kakhangaza, kaphungwon thada ramik katat."
"Phanit kachida phungda chatlaga, Tangkhul ngashan thot thada."

English Translation & Meaning:

"The Haora shawl is the preeminent symbol of Tangkhul male dignity and ancestral honor."
"Woven in bold black, white, and red bands, adorned with delicate peacock-eye (Ramik) embroidery."
"Draped across the shoulders during festivals, embodying timeless Tangkhul identity and valor."

Procedural Sequence / Observance Steps:

1. Hand-spinning and dyeing of indigenous cotton using natural vegetable and bark dyes.
2. Setting up traditional backstrap loin loom (Kashan kashak).
3. Weaving the distinct tripartite colored bands: Pure white central field with black and red borders.
4. Hand-stitching the intricate geometric Ramik motifs along the longitudinal seam.
5. Formal presentation to adult males during ceremonial festival occasions.

Ceremonial Participants & Roles:

Master Women Weavers, Tangkhul Men, Cultural Guilds